

PITCH DECK | CRESTA DEAL STRATEGY & OPERATIONS MANAGER

One seat here architects complex enterprise deals with Sales, owns approval workflows as escalation owner from quote through signature, trains Sales on pricing and deal construction, and runs win/loss retros on the quote-to-cash lifecycle. I have already run every piece of that loop.

CPQ and approval-workflow ownership, Salesforce fluency, and a win/loss discipline built to survive the quarter after close, not just the signature.

\$700K+ margin recovered in 2 quarters via deal-by-deal retro at Sensata

53% to 61% distributor margin lift from restructured contract terms

Guardrail engine + Finance-auditable approval trail, founder of PriceKeel

1,200 deals retro'd against a \$627M target across 3 regions, 4 product families, 20 lines

Claude AI agents automating recurring deal analysis at Applied Materials

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A Deal Strategy & Operations seat is three jobs in one: deal architecture, approval ownership, and a win/loss discipline Sales can actually use.

What losing that discipline runs into

A quote-to-cash process without a clear escalation owner does not fail at the signature. It fails earlier, as a creative deal structure nobody stress-tested, a CPQ configuration Sales routes around, and a win/loss pattern nobody wrote down until it repeats next quarter.

Sales needs training on pricing and deal construction they will actually use mid-negotiation, not a policy doc they read once and forget.

The fix is not another approval gate. It is someone who treats deal architecture, approval ownership and win/loss retrospective as one connected loop instead of three separate jobs.

What I have already run

At **PriceKeel**, I built and run the CPQ configuration, approval workflow and Finance-auditable trail myself, the same escalation-owner role this seat holds from quote to signature.

At **Sensata**, I ran a win/loss-style retrospective on 1,200 deals one by one inside the Bleeders and Leakers program, then restructured contract terms that moved distributor margins from 53% to 61%.

Both mean I have sat on the deal-architecture side and the approval-governance side of the same gate, not just one or the other.

Partner with Sales to architect complex enterprise transactions, own approval workflows as escalation owner from quote through final signature, drive end-to-end improvements across the quote-to-cash lifecycle, train Sales on pricing and deal construction, and lead win/loss analysis and deal retrospectives is describing this exact loop.

What the Deal Strategy & Operations Manager opening asks for, and where the proof already sits.

What the role covers

- Partner with sales teams to architect complex enterprise transactions and build creative deal structures.*
- Own approval workflows and act as escalation owner from quote through final signature.*
- Drive end-to-end improvements across the quote-to-cash lifecycle; hands-on CPQ administration, strong Salesforce fluency.*
- Provide training to sales on pricing and deal construction; lead win/loss analysis and deal retrospectives.*

My Proof

- Complex deal architecture and escalation ownership:** built and run PriceKeel's guardrail engine and final-approval record daily, reviewing every creative deal structure and discount exception before signature.
- Quote-to-cash and CPQ:** set up and run CRM and CPQ configuration, forecast and pipeline reviews, and deal approvals at PriceKeel; automated a Salesforce-based Mar-Tech stack for closed-loop reporting at Plug Power.
- Win/loss analysis and deal retrospectives:** led the Bleeders and Leakers program at Sensata, a deal-by-deal retro on 1,200 opportunities against a \$627M target, recovering \$700K+ in margin in 2 quarters.
- Training Sales on pricing and deal construction:** built sales enablement, decks and case studies, for 50+ reps at Sensata, lifting win rates 30%.

Bleeders and Leakers: a win/loss retro built to survive the quarter after close.

Built as a BU-wide Power BI system covering 1,200 pricing opportunities against a \$627M target across 3 regions, 4 product families and 20 product lines, with every gap traced to a specific deal before leadership set the next quarter's targets.

\$700K+

Margin Recovered, 2 Quarters

Deal-by-deal retro against competitive gaps and each customer's own willingness to pay, the same rigor a win/loss analysis runs on every closed deal.

53% to 61%

Distributor Margin Lift

Restructured the channel's contract terms and documented them for governance review, so the new margin held past the first quarter.

\$433M

Margin Gaps Surfaced

Every gap traced to a specific deal by salesperson and product line, the same record-level detail an escalation owner depends on at signature.

At PriceKeel that same instinct became the operating model: I built the CPQ configuration and the approval trail myself, so the deal structure and the approval record are never two different stories.

What the first month owning Deal Strategy & Operations at Cresta looks like.

WEEK 1

Learn the CPQ configuration and the escalation path

Sit with Sales, Finance and RevOps to walk the current quote-to-cash flow end to end, shadow one complex enterprise deal from quote to final signature, and map where approval workflows slow Sales down today.

Why first: the same instinct that had me learn a BU's own pricing patterns before building the Bleeders and Leakers model on top of them.

WEEK 2-3

Own a full deal cycle as escalation owner

Take ownership of one deal pipeline end to end: architect the deal structure with Sales, resolve escalations through final signature, and start the first win/loss retro on deals that closed or stalled in the last quarter.

Why now: the same deal-by-deal discipline that recovered \$700K+ in margin inside the Bleeders and Leakers program.

WEEK 4

Ship the first pricing and deal-construction training

Pull the first win/loss retro's findings into a short training for Sales on pricing and deal construction, and publish one quote-to-cash process improvement Sales can use before the next quarter's deal reviews start.

Why this fast: a win/loss retro only earns its keep if Sales can act on it without waiting for the next one.

CLOSE

You are hiring someone to keep deal architecture, approval ownership and win/loss discipline honest across every complex transaction. I have already built that discipline, from both sides of the deal.

The core proof is Sensata: a Power BI system retrofitting **1,200 pricing opportunities against a \$627M target**, distributor margins restructured **from 53% to 61%**, and \$700K+ in margin recovered in 2 quarters through deal-by-deal review and retrospective.

What is harder to find is someone who has also spent the last several months owning the CPQ configuration and the final-approval audit trail for his own company's deal flow. **I built that at PriceKeel**, so the quote-to-cash discipline this role runs across Sales, Finance and RevOps is not something I would need to learn on the job, only which deal pipeline to point it at first.

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